

BLACKBERRIES AND HYBRID BERRIES *Rubus fruticosus*

Blackberries and their many hybrids are all descended from wild brambles and will need careful training to prevent them from trailing on the ground or taking over your plot. However, the taste of these sweet, juicy berries is well worth the effort as they are very easy to grow.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Prepare your site in advance—dig in some well-rotted manure or compost, and weed well. Blackberries and other hybrid berries will need plenty of space and a good support system—both for the health of the plant, and for easy picking. There are several options: train them over an arch, or station posts along the length of your row and fix horizontal wires between them (see raspberries). The trailing stems can then be looped over the wires and tied in.

Site carefully: both blackberries and hybrid berries prefer soil that is well drained and need shelter from the wind, but while blackberries will tolerate partial shade, hybrid berries need full



Train your blackberries over wires.

sun. Plant canes to the depth of their existing soil marks, leaving 10–16 ft (3–5 m) between plants, depending on the variety chosen.

CROP CARE

Mulch plants with straw in early spring and pull up any suckers that appear. Cut down canes once they have fruited. New canes will grow in the second year. The plants are generally